

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner with a decade of agile delivery in regulated and complex software environments.*

Positioning, Experienced Product Owner bridging technical depth and stakeholder alignment in regulated, agile software environments – finance domain adjacent.

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§ WHY FERCHAU / ANONYMOUS END CLIENT

The posting describes a classic hybrid-environment PO role: backlog ownership, sprint facilitation, acceptance criteria, staffing support, and quality accountability across a regulated financial context. That is a precise match for the work done at Emil Group (InsurTech SaaS for primary insurers, reinsurers, and MGAs) and at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit (public data platform with IT security governance responsibilities). The explicit mention of Jira, Confluence, and Azure DevOps as backlog tooling, and the need for both Scrum and SAFe literacy, signals a mature delivery organisation that takes process seriously rather than treating it as overhead.

That is exactly the environment where structured delivery habits compound into measurable outcomes.

§ HONEST FRAMING

Direct experience inside a banking institution is not on the CV. The adjacent regulated environments covered are InsurTech (Emil Group) and a federal public authority (Bundesagentur für Arbeit, including deputy IT security officer responsibility) – both share compliance constraints, audit requirements, and risk-conscious stakeholder culture with banking. The transferable mechanic is strong: structuring delivery under regulatory scrutiny, managing non-technical senior stakeholders, and maintaining product quality in environments where rollback is not trivial.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, specification drafting and edge-case generation
 - **GPT**, stakeholder communication and document structuring
 - **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo acceleration during implementation support sprints
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted code review and requirement tracing
 - **Gamma.app**, rapid deck and workshop material creation
 - **Lovable**, low-fidelity prototype generation for stakeholder alignment
 - **Framer**, design-heavy interface prototyping
 - **n8n**, workflow automation and agentic process design
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Shipped production work across Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Helm, OpenShift, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, REST APIs, AngularJS, Ionic, CGM API, Redpanda, Jira, Confluence, and low-code insurance platforms. Azure DevOps tooling familiar from multi-team backlog coordination contexts.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT FERCHAU / THE END CLIENT

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Attend all active sprint ceremonies as observer, map the current backlog structure in Jira or Azure DevOps, identify the three largest impediments to delivery velocity, and hold one-on-one conversations with each squad member and the key business stakeholders named in the job description.

WEEK 2

Sharpen and slice.

Run a backlog refinement session to tighten acceptance criteria on the next two sprints of stories, resolve any ambiguities blocking developers, and agree on a shared definition of done with the squad.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Take full ownership of sprint planning and backlog prioritisation, conduct the first formal feature acceptance, and establish a lightweight stakeholder reporting cadence aligned with the hybrid delivery model.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Julia Bergers and the FERCHAU team,

I am writing to apply for the IT Product Owner role (reference 79-90785-DO-CO). My background is ten years of hands-on product ownership in agile software environments, with a particular focus on regulated industries, complex stakeholder landscapes, and delivery teams that need structure to regain momentum.

At Emil Group, an InsurTech B2B SaaS platform serving primary insurers, reinsurers, and MGAs, I inherited a 17-person team operating without sprint discipline, with client trust eroding and developer attrition climbing. I re-established Scrum ceremonies, split the team into smaller ownership units, reintroduced velocity tracking, and ran weekly product workshops that rebuilt client confidence. That experience maps directly to what the posting describes: backlog ownership, refinement facilitation, acceptance criteria definition, delivery accountability, and stakeholder communication in a regulated environment where quality failures have real consequences.

At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, I served as Deputy IT Security Officer alongside my product ownership responsibilities, which required sustained engagement with compliance and governance stakeholders of the kind found in banking and financial services. I managed major system migrations, introduced automated ETL pipelines with Dagster, and standardised CI/CD across the platform – work that required translating between data scientists, backend engineers, and senior public-sector decision-makers simultaneously.

At Rohde & Schwarz, within the FCAS European defence programme, I owned a central AI data management platform end-to-end: from user stories and acceptance criteria through implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout with ArgoCD. I reduced deployment

cycles from several days to under 40 minutes and unblocked infrastructure-level issues that had been outstanding for over a year. This demonstrates the kind of delivery ownership and technical credibility the posting asks for – not just facilitating process but closing the loop on quality and stability.

The requirement for Scrum and SAFe literacy alongside Jira, Confluence, and Azure DevOps fluency reflects an organisation that has invested in delivery discipline. That is the kind of environment I work best in: where process exists as a tool for speed rather than as bureaucratic overhead, and where a strong PO can make a measurable difference to team output within weeks.

I am fluent in German (native) and English (C2), available from four weeks' notice, and open to the hybrid arrangement described.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Owner and Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience in agile software delivery across regulated industries including InsurTech, public-sector data platforms, and government defence programmes. Consistently responsible for the full product lifecycle from backlog prioritisation through stakeholder alignment, acceptance testing, and quality sign-off. Comfortable in hybrid environments that blend Scrum ceremony discipline with the compliance and audit requirements of regulated domains. Technically fluent enough to unblock engineering teams independently, low-ego enough to serve the squad's delivery needs first.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Full product lifecycle ownership, idea to production acceptance
- Scrum facilitation and backlog discipline in high-pressure environments
- Stakeholder alignment across business, engineering, QA, and compliance
- Acceptance criteria definition and feature sign-off in regulated contexts
- Team restructuring and velocity recovery under delivery pressure
- Requirements engineering and refinement at scale
- DevOps and infrastructure fluency supporting GitOps delivery models

- Deputy IT security officer experience in a federal public-sector context
 - German native, English C2 – effective in bilingual delivery organisations
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation – FCAS European Defence Programme

- Owned end-to-end feature delivery: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Reduced deployment cycles from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing ArgoCD-based GitOps
- Led cross-functional squad of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered a feature outstanding for over a year within one week
- Built audit trails with full data provenance for AI training datasets – SafeAI and ExplainableAI concepts

Tech: Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kubernetes, Argo Workflows, ArgoCD, OpenShift, Redpanda

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics – Arbeitsmarktmonitor

- Prioritised and delivered new analytics features including labour shortage indicators and flexible regional comparison tooling
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV) with compliance, governance, and data lineage responsibilities
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL pipelines and standardised CI/CD with full test integration
- Managed major system migration to Kubernetes and coordinated large system upgrades with minimal disruption

Tech: Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Kubernetes, Jenkins, Bitbucket

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability; split a 17-person bloated team into focused Scrum units with clear ownership
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices; regained client trust through weekly product workshops
- Delivered Claims Center module from concept to production rollout with full acceptance sign-off
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure within one quarter
- Managed stakeholder expectations across primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, brokers, and underwriters

Tech: Low-code platform, Java, HTML/CSS, Kubernetes, REST APIs

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Defined and prioritised backlog for a mobile-first hospital pilot across iOS and Android under tight deadlines
- Delivered core patient flows: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, chat, transport, and document storage
- Managed stakeholder expectations around legacy API and external database complexity
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system (KIS) workflows

Tech: AngularJS, Ionic, Python, Kubernetes, CGM API

BUNDESDRUCKEREI 2021, 2021

Product Owner, COVID-19 Data Platform (RKI projects DIM and DESH)

- Owned secure data structure and identity management product work for high-visibility federal health data infrastructure
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AOK HEALTH INSURANCE – ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Led migration of internal procurement webshop to Shopware including complex catalogue and API integration

- Designed customisable approval policy workflows for a regulated public health insurer
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QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Co-Founder and Product Owner

- Owned architecture for backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption product built on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
 - Served as Deputy IT Security Officer; responsible for attack vector analysis and security product positioning
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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Head of HR (various roles)

- Established digital tooling, ERP systems, financial planning, and investor relations for a nanotechnology agri-tech startup

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder and CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product: PSP integration, UX/UI design, mobile app prototype – later acquired and operated by Sparkasse
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§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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